

GREEN GOBLIN

Spider-Man's greatest enemy

GREEN GOBLIN

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Norman Osborn

OCCUPATION

Criminal/Industrialist

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

5 ft 11 in

WEIGHT

185 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Reddish-brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Spider-Man #14

(July 1964)

POWERS

Superhuman strength, endurance, and reactions, endowed by Goblin Formula, have increased steadily over time; weaponry includes armoured costume, Goblin Glider and Pumpkin Bombs.

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES The Enforcers, the Cable of Scier, Crime-Master, Jackal, the Sinister Twelve

FOES Spider-Man

ISSUE #1

Tearing up with the Enforcers, the Green Goblin is determined to destroy Spider-Man.



Norman Osborn reveals himself to be the Green Goblin.

For almost as long as there has been a SPIDER-MAN, so too has the Green Goblin existed. Spider-Man's arch nemesis, the Green Goblin is the insane, malevolent alter ego of that once-respectable industrialist, Norman Osborn. Despite their mutual antagonism, the relationship between the pair is complex. Although the Green Goblin loathes and resents Spider-Man's very existence, for a long time Norman Osborn and Peter Parker shared a deep mutual respect and admiration. Osborn saw in the orphaned Peter the son he really wanted.



GENESIS OF THE GOBLIN

Long before his transformation into the Green Goblin, Norman Osborn was an ambitious businessman, quite prepared to sacrifice others on the altar of his own success. The co-founder of chemical company Oscorp, Osborn gained total control by framing his business partner, Professor Mendel Stromm, for embezzlement. The Goblin Formula that was to prove Osborn's undoing was a concoction detailed in the professor's notes, but it was Osborn's attempt to manufacture it for himself that resulted in the solution exploding in his face. As a result of this explosion, Osborn's strength, stamina and reflexes were enhanced but his sanity began to erode.

As the Green Goblin, Osborn wished to lead New York's criminal underworld and he set out to gain the respect of the key gangs by destroying Spider-Man. He developed high-tech weaponry specifically designed to achieve this end. Despite discovering Spider-Man's true identity, the Green Goblin was ultimately defeated: an electric shock, sustained during a battle with the web-slinger, caused Osborn to regain his sanity and lose all memory of his malevolent alter ego. Peter Parker judged that it was better to allow Osborn to resume his old life.

STRIKING AT SPIDER-MAN

Osborn's regained sanity proved fragile. Time and again his inner demon—the Green Goblin—reasserted control, and

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Amazing Spider-Man #39–40

The Green Goblin discovers Peter Parker's secret identity, the Goblin is unmasked as Norman Osborn and we learn about his origins.

• Amazing Spider-Man #121–2

A dramatic battle between the Green Goblin and Spider-Man results in the death of Gwen Stacy and the Goblin's own, apparent, demise.

• Amazing Spider-Man #134–7

Norman Osborn's son Harry discovers that Peter Parker is really Spider-Man and, looking for revenge, becomes the second Green Goblin.

...Peter repeatedly brought Osborn back ...the businessman's grip on sanity ...more and more tenuous. During this ...Peter's then-girlfriend, Gwen Stacy, met ...and, overwhelmed by his charisma, ...pregnant by him. Nine months later, she ...birth to twins, Gabriel and Sarah, in France, ...their existence a secret from Peter. ...following Gwen's return to New York, an ...altercation between her and a desperately ...Osborn served to destabilize him ...Determined to punish both her and ...Spider-Man, when Osborn reverted to ...the Green Goblin he ...killed Gwen and ...her to the top ...Brooklyn Bridge.



To protect his father, Harry Osborn says he is the Green Goblin.

All the Green Goblins have shared similar equipment.

OTHER GREEN GOBLINS

In becoming the Green Goblin, Norman Osborn inadvertently founded a Goblin dynasty. After witnessing his father's apparent death, a mentally unstable Harry Osborn adopted the Green Goblin mantle and attempted to destroy Spider-Man. Although Harry eventually put his father's legacy behind him, even settling down with a wife and child, life's pressures finally drove him back to the Goblin formula. Tragically, his body was killed by the deadly concoction. Twice, the Goblin name has been borne by non-Osborns, with Harry's psychiatrist, Bart Hamilton, and Phil Ulrich, the nephew of reporter Ben Ulrich, both being pretenders to the Goblin crown.

More recently, Gabriel Stacy, the son of Norman Osborn and Gwen Stacy, injected himself with the Goblin formula to save his own life. Now the fifth Green Goblin, Gabriel remains at large, somewhere in Europe.

The third Green Goblin is revealed.



HEY... YOU'RE NOT HARRY... YOU'RE HIS PSYCHIATRIST... BART HAMILTON



The Goblin uses a variety of grenades which look like Halloween pumpkins.

A casualty of war, the Green Goblin throws Gwen Stacy to her death.



The ensuing confrontation with Spider-Man resulted in Gwen's death and in Osborn being impaled by his own Goblin Glider.

Peter Parker assumed that Osborn had been killed by this impact but he had not allowed for the extraordinary potency of the Goblin formula. While lying on a mortuary slab, Osborn's body suddenly revived. To keep his survival secret, Osborn substituted his own body with that of an anonymous drifter.

Harry Osborn prevents the Ultimate universe Green Goblin from destroying Spider-Man. Norman Osborn had injected himself with a spider-serum. Rather than endowing him with Spider-Man's powers, the serum transformed Osborn into a crazed demonic creature.



Osborn travelled to Europe, where he took control of a secret society known as the SCRIBES. At the same time he watched over Gwen's children, tending to their physical needs while warping their minds against Peter Parker by convincing them that Peter was their father and had abandoned them.

NORMAN OSBORN, HERO

Recently, Osborn has worked hard to become a hero in the eyes of the world. As the new director of the THUNDERBOLTS, he played a major role in the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326–7), using his villains-turned-heroes to help fight off the SKRULLS and even killing Queen VERANKE himself on live television. He spun this event into being chosen to dismantle SHIELD and head up a new agency called HAMMER.

Once in power, Osborn set up the Cabal, a darker version of the ILLUMINATI which strives to control the world from behind the scenes. As director of HAMMER, he also formed a new AVENGERS team composed of villains wearing the costumes of heroes. He led it himself as a combination of IRON MAN and CAPTAIN AMERICA called the Iron Patriot. AD, MF



Tingling spider-sense, awesome strength, and superfast reflexes—Spider-Man needs all of these things to survive the Green Goblin's arsenal of weapons and enhanced body.